The Devil Pig News

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ACHTUNG MINEN!

HOMELAND DEFENSE EDITION

ONE WRONG STEP: MINES AND MINE WARFARE

Although landmines were in widespread use during the First World War, it was in the Second that the landmine really came into its own. In the early part of the war, the Germans found themselves dealing with British mines used in North Africa, and Soviet mines used all along the Eastern Front. In the late part of the war, the Germans used their vast experience with mine warfare to liberally seed mines through all their defensive positions; the Normandy beaches alone had thousands of mines liberally scattered along every approach and draw. In Normandy, minefields were German-laid, and targeted the Allies. So let's discuss what you could expect in a German minefield.

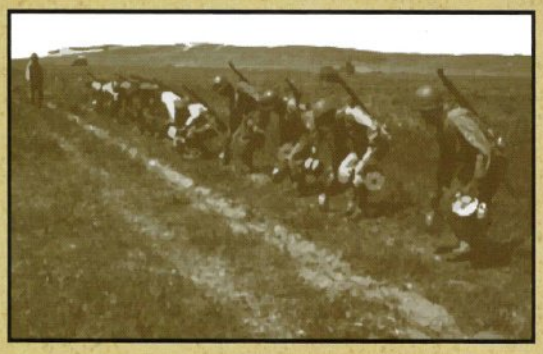
There are many different types of mines, but they boil down to three general classes: the anti-tank tellermine (about twelve pounds of explosives), the small anti-personnel schu-mine (made of wood and nearly impossible to find with a mine detector), and the sinister and much-hated bounding s-mine (which flew up about three feet and then exploded throwing lethal metal out about twelve feet.)

Mines are an area denial weapon. By spreading mines through an area, you deny it to enemy movement. Any unit which stumbles into a minefield will slow; anyone who steps on a mine will be crippled at best. In fact, most mines used in anti-personnel roles were designed to injure, not kill. A soldier with a leg blown off would need stretcher bearers to carry him off the field, thereby taking three or even four soldiers out of action with one blast. Anti-tank mines, on the other hand, would be designed to blast through the bottom of a vehicle and instantly kill or disable it.

Hollywood is full of classic scenes



where a frightened soldier stands shivering on top of a mine while the rest of his squad try desperately to save him by holding down a trigger or fuse. In almost all German mines, this is totally fiction. Mines were triggered by pressure on their trigger, set to about 75 pounds for anti-personnel mines, or about 570 pounds for anti-tank mines. Once the pressure trigger was depressed, the chemical or electric fuse would trip almost instantly and detonate the mine. The only regularly deployed German mine with any trigger delay was the S-mine, which had a slight delay built in to allow the soldier who triggered it to move off before it popped up from the ground.



German engineers and soldiers were experts in defensive warfare, and they frequently mixed multiple types of mines in one minefield. Schu-mines would be spread in dense packs, with tripwire-triggered s-mines to catch Allied engineers unaware. Tellermines would be laid along roads and in ditches where vehicles might try to detour, and other anti-personnel mines added in to hit infantry accompanying the tanks. And many minefields would be clearly marked, warning the enemy what was waiting. Of course, some of the clearly marked minefields were also decoys having no mines at all. This meant any unit approaching a potentially mined area had to assume there were mines there, whether or not any were found.

And, just to make it more interesting, many mines had anti-tampering devices which would trigger the mine if it was interfered with. The most devastating was the one used on some tellermines. It was UNDERNEATH the mine, had its own fuse which couldn't be removed from above, and triggered the mine if it was lifted. Another popular device was a false fuse on top which would detonate a mine if removed, since the typical way to disarm a mine was to unscrew the fuse.

A solemn testament to the amount of mines used by the Germans in defending Festung Europa: even today, occasional mines are recovered from French farm land, and people have been injured or even killed by mines buried over seventy years ago. Mines were the infantryman's nightmare, where one wrong step could unman or kill you without warning. Their addition to scenarios will require mine-clearing teams to pick their way through deadly fields while the infantry bunches up and slows, waiting for a clear safe path to move through. Although units might not be killed, they will be suppressed or forced to halt; no soldier in his right mind would voluntarily run through a known minefield (aside from the Russians, who did force Penal Battalions to do exactly that on the Ostfront.)

I hope this educates you a little about the infernal landmine, and how you might add them to your own scenarios. Until next time, here's hoping you haven't used your last Battle Rage when the enemy calls an assault!

Will B.

WATCH YOUR STEP!

One more effort and the road to Carentan is opened. A last position to storm, and the entire 4th Infantry Division will hurl onto the German lines. But watch your step, soldiers! The battlefield is trapped. Protect the minesweepers and let them do their job. They must open the way.

Composition of the Armies



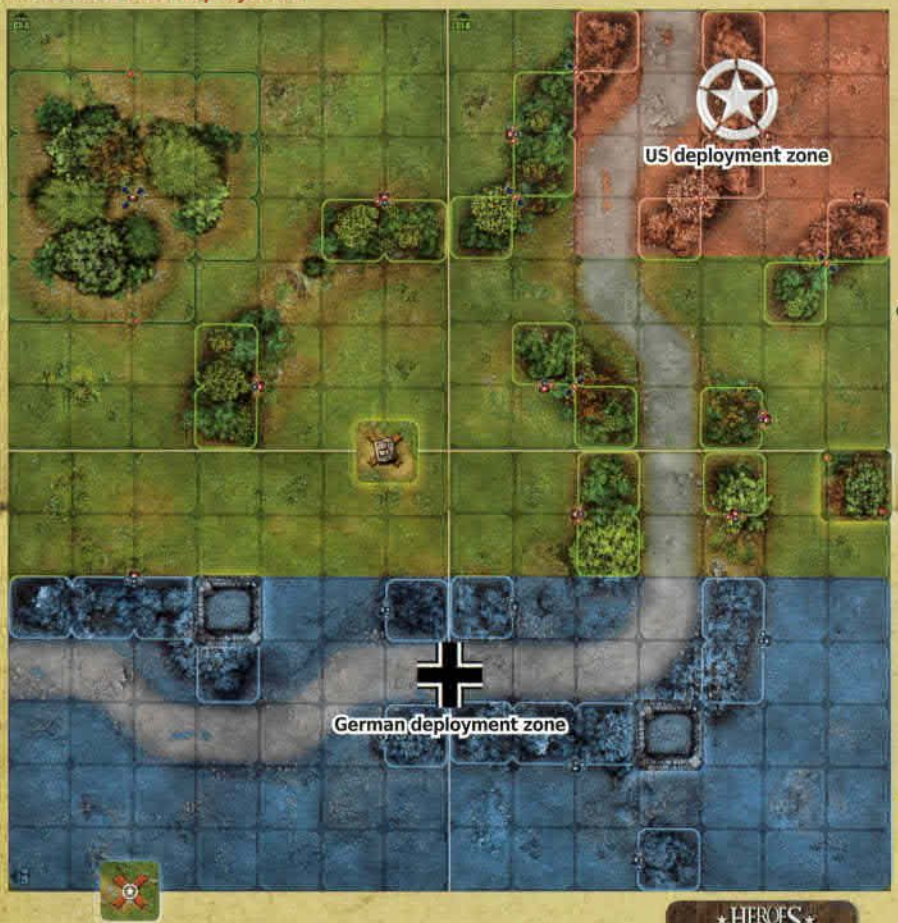








Battlefield and Deployment



German player deploys his units first in his deployment zone. He can deploy the two landfields at up to 3 interspaces from his deployment zone.

American player deploys his troops in his deployment zone.

Without looking at them, place **1** Bonus tactics marker on the battlefield.





Remove the following cards from decks:

Precision, Surprise, Weak Point, Bogged Down, Ram, Panzerfaust and all the **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Precision, Surprise, It Bounced Right Off It, Hit and Run, Ram, Don't stop!, Repairs, Surprise, Booby Trap and all the **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



The American player has initiative; place the corresponding marker on Turn 1.

Each player draws 4 cards.

Terrain tiles
C3-A, C1-B, C4-B, C2-B

Victory Conditions and Particular Information:

This game lasts **6** turns.



The goal for the American player is to control the main objective before the end of Turn 6.
He must control it with any vehicle.

American Victory: The American player wins the game if he controls the main objective at the end of Turn **6**.
It's a major victory if the American player mineswept at least 50% of the mine tokens.

German Victory: The German player wins the game if the American player doesn't controls the main objective by the end of Turn **6**.

It's a major victory if more than 50% of the German mine tokens are still on the board at the end of the game (and the American player didn't fulfill his victory conditions).





JUNO BEACH

The Juno Beach landings provided flank support for the main invasion beaches. As men and materiel arrived under heavy German fire, beachmaster R
hound Winnie)cleared the way for impressive gains as the Canadians advanced farther than anyone on D-Day.

In order to play this scenario, you need the **Heroes of Normandie** core box, the **Commonwealth Army Box** and the Scenarios Pack **D-Day** (mandatory). If you don't have as they cost the same amount of army points.

Composition of the Armies (UK : 1045pts / Ge : 845pts)













Battlefield and Deployment

